

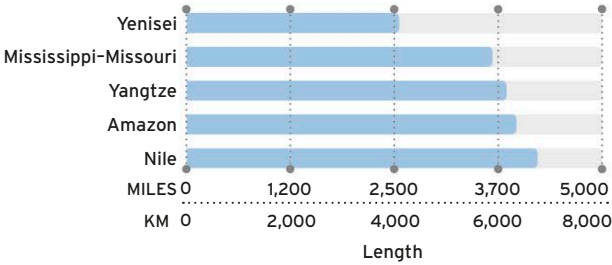


△ DESERT LIFELINE

Passing through arid landscapes over most of its course, the Nile provides a vital water supply for drinking and agricultural use. It is also an important transportation route used by millions of people each day.

THE WORLD'S LONGEST RIVERS

The accurate measurement of a river's length can be problematic. In some cases, it is difficult to identify a river's source or mouth, and over its course a river may split into many different channels. Although figures for the lengths of the longest rivers vary, the measurements below are the most widely recognized.



△ VERSATILE PLANT

A species of aquatic sedge, papyrus forms tall, reedlike beds in the Nile's shallow waters. Since ancient Egyptian times, papyrus has been used to make various items, from scrolls to boats.